

GREY BANNER ALERT



Serious Incident – Final Notice

CRITICAL RISK: Mobile Plant

Date of Incident	30th June 2026	Time of Incident	9:40 AM
Directorate / Region	RMO – Kimberley Region	Main Roads or Contractor	Contractor
isafe Event Type	Damage / Loss	isafe Incident Number	INC-0000368
Actual Consequence	Moderate	Potential Consequence	Major
Reportable to WorkSafe	No	Type of Notifiable Incident	N/A

Incident Short Description	Loader rolled over whilst undertaking operations in the materials pit.
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Executive Summary

At approximately 9:40 am, a loader operator was working within the materials pit and had filled the loader bucket with material. While reversing away from the gravel stockpile, a large rock fell from the bucket and came to rest on the ground behind the machine.

The operator then proceeded to stockpile the material. During this activity, the loader travelled over the rock that had fallen from the bucket. As a result, the loader became unstable, tilted, and slowly rolled onto its right-hand side while the bucket remained fully loaded. The operator was able to safely exit the loader and did not sustain any injuries because of the incident.

Following the incident, the area was immediately isolated and made safe. Work in the vicinity was suspended while the investigation was undertaken to confirm there was no spills or damage to the loader.



Contributing Factors

- The loader was operating on uneven ground which likely contributed to instability by increasing lateral and vertical movement of the machine.
- Tyres were suspected to be overinflated, contributing to machine instability.
- Material within the bucket was unevenly distributed, resulting in a lateral shift of the centre of gravity and contributing to the rollover event.
- The loader bucket was positioned at a high elevation during travel, significantly reducing the machine's centre of gravity and stability.
- The loader operator held a VOC to operate a Volvo Wheel Loader and not the higher capacity machine he was actually operating.

Corrective Actions

- Load operator to undertake a post incident Verification of Competency (VOC).
- Pit Operations SWMS to be reviewed to verify hazards such as uneven ground, and any other hazards such as rocks in the work area.
- Plant Risk Assessments and plant daily pre-starts to be reviewed and spot checks on operators to be conducted to verify hazard awareness and knowledge on how to mitigate risks.
- Site communications (UHF radios and mobile coverage) to be reviewed to ensure sufficient communication coverage throughout the site is achieved.

Distribution of Notice

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations